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KIKUYU-ENGLISH DICTIONARY

Edited by

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PREFACE

MY first copy of Barlow's *Kikuyu Grammar*—it bore a longer title which characteristically sought to imply the study to be tentative—had written on its fly-leaf the first Kikuyu proverb I ever learned: *Kūmenya werū nĩ kũūtinda*. This might be freely translated to mean that one gets to know a town by pottering around its streets.

There is no short cut to the acquisition of a sound working knowledge of Kikuyu or, indeed, of any other language. But pottering around among its people, getting to know, and getting to love them and their country, will help a great deal. So, too, will the hours spent browsing in the pages of this dictionary. It has outgrown beyond recognition the format in which the first cyclostyled vocabulary appeared which my wife and I produced. My thanks go to its present editor and his collaborators, as well as to those many people, not least to Mr. A. R. Barlow, from whom such a wealth of additional material has been obtained. Of this co-operative task another Kikuyu proverb is aptly descriptive: *Kamũingĩ koyaga ndĩrĩ*, while yet a third describes the result: *Kenyũ na kenyũ cioyanagĩra nda*.

LEONARD

Archbishop of East Africa

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

THIS dictionary has been compiled from two main sources, a 'Tentative Dictionary of the Kikuyu Language' prepared by the Rev. L. J. Beecher (now Archbishop of East Africa) and Mrs. Beecher and issued in cyclostyled form in 1935, and the collected material in the possession of Mr. A. R. Barlow, formerly of the Church of Scotland Mission in Kikuyuland. Mr. Barlow began to note down words as far back as 1904, shortly after the first publication of Kikuyu texts by the Rev. A. W. McGregor of the C.M.S. Two other pioneers were also at work in the field at that time, the Rev. Fr. Héméry and the Rev. Canon Leakey, Mrs. Beecher's father, from whose skeleton Kikuyu Dictionary the Beechers drew 'many additional words and much help'. Closely associated with them in this work was Mr. Matthew Njoroge wa Kabetu, whose name deserves to be remembered alongside that of Mr. Reuben Mūriũki wa Kihuha, for many years assistant to Mr. Barlow, who lost his life in the Mau Mau troubles.

In 1954 the School of Oriental and African Studies in the University of London gave permission to Mr. T. G. Benson, Lecturer in Bantu Languages at the School and a former Education Officer in Kenya, to undertake the work of editing a Standard Dictionary of the Kikuyu Language based on the material available as mentioned above and containing some new features, in particular: (a) a tonal classification prepared under the direction of Mr. A. E. Sharp, Lecturer in Phonetics at the School, (b) a full statement of the verbal root extensions.

During the course of the preparation of the dictionary, which lasted over six years, the Editor had the co-operation and invaluable assistance of a number of Kikuyu, in particular Messrs. P. S. Kahahu, S. Karĩmĩ, and J. Wainaina, all university graduates, and for a shorter period Mr. J. Maina. Grateful acknowledgement is due for their keen sense of responsibility for the standard that the dictionary should set and their desire to see a worthy representation of their language in print. Occasional help was also received from Messrs. N. Njũrũri, P. Kĩai, and K. Gĩcau. The Rev. Fr. Ghilardi of the Catholic Mission, Imenti, not only agreed to forgo publication of a separate dictionary on which he had been working, but willingly offered assistance by answering queries on difficult words. Acknowledgements are also made to the following: the Rev. A. Page, Secretary of the United Kikuyu

Language Committee, for co-operation in dealing with rare words; Dr. F. Irvine, Mr. Douglas Leakey, and Dr. Verdcourt who helped in checking the names of trees and plants; Dr. Jean Fisher who generously contributed vocabularies of words and phrases used in agriculture and domestic life. The contributions of Mr. Barlow are too numerous to mention in detail: generations to come will remember with gratitude all that he poured into this compilation from his rich store of knowledge both of Kikuyu language and custom.

The Editor acknowledges his debt to Battiscombe's *Trees and Flowering Shrubs of Kenya* for a list of names of trees in Kikuyu many of which have been incorporated in this work.

CORRIGENDA

- p. 68 *icokero should follow after -cokereru.*
- p. 254 Mau-mau² 1. 3 *for 'anti-European, anti-Christian' read 'anti-colonialistic'.*
- p. 340 *for nyakĩo, see under kĩa read nyakĩyo, see under kĩa, and place after nyakĩwariĩ.*

INTRODUCTION

NOTES FOR THE USER OF THE DICTIONARY

Grammatical categories

The grammatical category of a Kikuyu word has no necessary connexion with the category of the word or words used in the English definition.

Citation

As a rule citations are given where they show the meaning of a word better than a translation. In a number of cases proverbs which form a significant part of the oral literature of the language are used for illustrative purposes. Citations consisting of proverbs or proverbial expressions always begin with a capital letter.

Personal and place-names

Personal and place-names are not included except where they are related to words already entered in the dictionary.

Diminutives, augmentatives, and abstracts

The entries under the heads of Diminutives (Class 12/13), Augmentatives (Class 7/8), and Abstracts (Class 14/6) are not intended to be exhaustive, and their absence must not be taken to mean that they cannot be used if required.

Reflexive verbs

Verbs whose roots appear to begin with *ĩ-* are listed as Reflexive when the first person singular in the simple tenses takes the form *ndĩ-* and not *n-* (i.e. some form of nasal). Such verbs should therefore be looked for under the initial letter of the root (i.e. minus the initial *ĩ-*).

Order of entries

The following order has been followed: *a, b, c, e, g, h, i, ĩ, k, m, mb, n, nd, ng, ng', nj, ny, o, (p), r, t, th, u, ũ, w, y.*

Nouns

Nouns are listed according to the first letter of the stem. The class prefixes are printed in Bold italic, the singular prefixed to the stem with the plural prefix following. When the prefix is

enclosed in a bracket it means that the use of the noun in that form is rare but possible. Where the prefix is not capable of being shown separately (as in the case of Class 9/10), nouns are listed according to the initial letter of the whole word. A word which appears to be a noun but which has no meaning, so far as is known, outside a given context, is shown in context with the word or words with which it is normally used, without assignment to any noun class unless there is anything to show the form of agreement.

The following is a table of the noun classes in Kikuyu together with the adjectival and pronominal concord prefixes:

Group	Classes	Prefixes		
		Nominal	Adjectival	Pronominal
I	1/2	mũ-/a-	mũ-/a-	ũ-/a-
II	3/4	mũ-/mĩ-	mũ-/mĩ-	ũ-/ĩ-
III	5/6	rĩ-, i-/ma-	rĩ-, i-/ma-	rĩ-/ma-
IV	7/8	kĩ-/i-, ci-	kĩ-/n-	kĩ-/i-, ci-
V	9/10	n-/n-	n-/n-	ĩ-/i-, ci-
VI	11/10	rũ-/n-	rũ-/n-	rũ-/i-, ci-
VII	12/13	ka-/tũ-	ka-/tũ-	ka-/tũ-
VIII	14/6	ũ-/ma-	mũ-/ma-	ũ-/ma-
IX	15/6	kũ-/ma-	kũ-/ma-	kũ-/ma-
	15a	kũ- (nomino-verbal)	kũ-	kũ-
X	16/15b	ha-/kũ- (locative)	ha-/kũ-	ha-/kũ-

Verbs

Verbs are listed according to the first letter of the root. They appear in the imperative form (i.e. normally with the addition of the simple suffix *-a*). The extensions are set out in a regular order, with the intention that unless the meaning is given in full the normal meaning of each extension is to be applied. Apart from a few special cases the passive is listed only when it occurs in a citation. It would be extremely unwise to claim that any treatment of verbal extensions was exhaustive, and it is hoped that errors and omissions will be pointed out and dealt with in any future edition of the dictionary.

The table of Extensions on p. xi has been followed:

Secondary and Tertiary Extensions are added where they are significant: e.g.

ĩgũrithia
gũrĩkĩra
hingũkĩra
ĩcokanĩrĩria
ĩcokia

<i>Extension</i>	<i>Example</i>	<i>Description</i>	<i>Abbreviation</i>
1. duplication	gūragūra	diminutive	dim.
2. ī-	īgūra	reflexive	refl.
3. -anga	gūraṅga	diffusive	diff.
4. -ana	gūrana	reciprocal	rec.
5. -ania	gūrania	causative reci- procal	caus. rec.
6. -anīra with v.t. with v.i.	gūranīra inanīra	applied reciprocal associative	app. rec. assoc.
7. -anīria with v.t. with v.i.	gūranīria inanīria	causative applied reciprocal causative associa- tive	caus. app. rec. caus. assoc.
8. -ia	inia	causative	caus.
9. -ithia	gūrithia	double causative	d. caus.
10. -īka (-eka)	gūrīka	stative and potential	st. pot.
11. -īra (-era)	gūrīra	applied	app.
12. -īria	inīria	causative applied	caus. app.
13. -īrīra (-erera)	gūrīrīra	intensive	inten.
14. -ūra (-ora)	hingūra	conversive	conv.
15. -ūrūra (-orora)	rutūrūra	intensive (con- versive)	inten.
16. -ūka (-oka)	hingūka	neuter	neut.
17. -ama	arama	static	stc.
18. -ata	ambata	tenacious	ten.
19. -ara	hingara	static	stc.
20. -ha	neneha	formative	normally en- tered as head word

The Primary Extensions have been entered in all cases where they are known to be in use; the others have been noted when they are in common use and add a significant idea to the main meaning. Reflexives will be found immediately after the extension to which they refer, e.g. **īhingūra** after **hingūra**.

The order given above is followed in the entries with Secondary Extensions following the Primary ones and Tertiary following Secondary.

PRONUNCIATION OF THE KIKUYU ALPHABET*

<i>Letter</i>	<i>Description</i>	<i>Examples</i>	<i>Phonetic Symbol (Armstrong)</i>
CONSONANTS			
b	voiced weak bilabial fricative	bībībībī	ʋ
c	voiceless prepalatal affricate (the sound varies with individuals resembling E. <i>ch</i> in <i>chop</i> or <i>sh</i> in <i>shop</i>)	cūcū	c
g	voiced weak velar fricative	igego	ɣ
h	glottal fricative, often voiced	haha	h
k	voiceless velar plosive	aka	k
m	voiced bilabial nasal	muuma	m
mb	prenasalized voiceless bilabial plosive (a single sound-unit with nasal 'kick-off')	mbembe	mb
n	voiced alveolar nasal	nene	n
nd	prenasalized voiced alveolar plosive	ndundu	nd
ng	prenasalized voiced velar plosive	nganga	ŋ
ng'	prenasalized voiced velar nasal (as in E. <i>singing</i>)	ng'ang'a	ŋ
nj	prenasalized voiced prepalatal affricate	njanja	nj
ny	voiced palatal nasal	inyanya	ɲ
r	voiced alveolar flap (a single tap of the tongue, not a roll)	raara	r
t	voiceless dental (in some areas alveolar) plosive	tūtī	t
th	voiced weak dental fricative (as in E. <i>that</i>)	thutha	ð
w	voiced labiovelar semi-vowel	wīra	w
y	voiced palatal semi-vowel	aya	y

VOWELS

(The doubling of a vowel indicates length, see p. xiii)

a	central open	tama : taama	ɑ : ɑɑ
e	front half-open	heha : heeha	ɛ : ɛɛ
i	front close	thithi : thiithi	ɪ : ɪi
ī	front half-close	gīko : gīiko	e : ee
o	back half-open	hota : hoota	ɔ : ɔɔ
u	back close	tura : tuura	u : uu
ū	back half-close	tūra : tūūra	o : oo

* For a more precise account see L. Armstrong, *Phonetic and Tonal Structure of Kikuyu*, O.U.P.

GUIDE TO THE PRONUNCIATION INDICATORS FOLLOWING THE ENTRIES

(Prepared by MR. A. E. SHARP, *Lecturer in Phonetics, School of
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THERE are three aspects of the pronunciation of Kikuyu about which the user of this dictionary requires more information than is supplied by the orthography currently authorized by the United Kikuyu Language Committee. One of these—tonal classification—is shown for almost every entry in the dictionary by a system of Roman numerals in parentheses which is explained below. The other two—vowel length and syllabicity—are made unambiguous where necessary by rewriting the entry in square brackets in accordance with the following conventions.

Vowel length

The length of a vowel is made explicit (for the head entry, but not for derivatives if any) in all cases where it is not predictable from the phonetic context. In this connexion there are two rules of importance:

- (i) Before *mb*, *nd*, *ng*, and *nj* in native Kikuyu words non-initial vowels are invariably long, initial vowels (unless the result of coalescence) invariably short. In the absence, therefore, of any indication to the contrary the single vowel-letter of the orthography must be interpreted accordingly.
- (ii) Vowels after an initial *w* representing a prefix elsewhere found as *ũ* (as in Class 14 nouns) are invariably long. Vowels after all other *w*'s are to be read as short unless doubled.

It follows from these rules that the first vowels indicated by the traditional spellings *ng'ombe* (cow) and *watho* (authority) are long, and that both *a*'s of *amba* (peg out) are short. In such cases no rewriting will be necessary. On the other hand, *thaaka* (play) and *roota* (dream) have to be rewritten in this way (U.K.L.C. spelling *thaka*, *rota*) since there is no way of knowing from the surrounding consonants whether the vowels are long or short (cf. *theka* (laugh) and *ruta* (teach) with short vowels).

Exceptions to rule (i) are found in loan-words in that:

- (a) internal vowels are sometimes short before nasal compounds, e.g. *maaninja* (manager), *karāmbaa* (colour-bar), where the breve will be used to indicate shortness;
- (b) initial vowels are sometimes long before nasal compounds, as in *iinjiniya* (engineer). Here the vowel-letter will be doubled in the rewriting.

Syllabicity

It is important to the user of the dictionary that the syllabication of a word be completely unambiguous if only because the tonal classification (see below) is set out with reference to the number of syllables a word contains. A system of writing Kikuyu has therefore been adopted which leaves syllable division in no doubt: wherever the U.K.L.C. spelling diverges from the system in use here the entry is rewritten.

The following is the information required to interpret the system:

- (i) Apart from a few particles and some contracted forms of the verb 'to be' (e.g. *mee* (they are) < *marĩ*), Kikuyu words do not end in long pure vowels. Other words written with a final geminated vowel-letter are to be understood as having a syllable frontier between the two like vowels. Thus *mbaa* (frost) consists of two syllables, *m̄ba-a*. Elsewhere in the word in a head entry a doubled vowel-letter always indicates a long vowel in a single syllable.
- (ii) Since long vowels are shown where necessary by doubling the appropriate letter, *y* and *w* are NOT used in the rewriting to indicate vowel length. Inasmuch, however, as *y* and *w* appear not to be distinctively audible in immediate proximity to *i* or *ĩ*, and *u* or *ũ* respectively, the letters are available for use as conventional SYLLABLE SEPARATORS in those cases where one of these vowels is followed (in the case of *i*, occasionally preceded) by another vowel with which it might otherwise be thought to be forming a diphthong. Thus *w* will be written in *ruwa* (be circumcised) exclusively to show that it is a disyllabic structure containing two SHORT vowels, as compared with, say, *tua* (pluck) which is a monosyllable. *w* will not, however, be required in *-kuua* (carry), since the length of the first vowel is shown by doubling and there is no possibility of *uu* forming a single syllable with a following *a*. Similarly, we shall write *rīa*

(eat), *thīya* (grind), *tīā* (honour), where the function of the *y* in the second word is to separate the two short vowels. The same is true of *mūrayika* (angel), though this word is apparently also heard as *mūraika* (i.e. with three syllables instead of four).

In order to reduce rewriting to a minimum, derivative verbs grouped under a rewritten head entry have not in general been themselves rewritten. In such cases the syllabication must be inferred from the rewriting of the head entry. Thus, for example, where *rūanīra* is found grouped under *rūa* [*rūwa*] (fight) it must be understood as *rūwanīra*. It is important to note that this principle of similar syllabication holds good equally for some cases where the head entry itself requires no rewriting, but ambiguity might arise in the derivatives. Thus what has usually been written as *gaithia* (help to divide) < *gaya* (divide) must be understood as *-gayithia*, being trisyllabic in contradistinction to *gaithia* (yield milk), which is disyllabic (i.e. *gai-thia*). Similarly, *ng'eera* < *ng'ea* (slaughter) is trisyllabic (*ng'e-e-ra*) as distinct from *ng'eera* (cut short, clip).

Tonal classification

Kikuyu is a so-called 'tone language'. This means that the form of a lexical item has to be stated not only in terms of its constituent vowels and consonants, but also in terms of the pitch features which characterize it in speech, since items of otherwise identical structure may be differentiated in this way alone. This is true, for instance, of such pairs as *enja* (dig) *enja* (shave), and *gũko* (pipe) *gũko* (deed). Words or parts of words have therefore to be grouped into tonal classes, and this must be effected on the basis of the identical tonal behaviour of all the members of a class in all contexts—however much the behaviour of the class as a whole may vary from one context to another. It is naturally impossible in a dictionary to give detailed information concerning this behaviour: it is to be hoped that such information will in due course be made available in a fully tonal grammar of Kikuyu. All that can be done here is to indicate the tonal classes to which the entries belong, so that what is known (or becomes known) for one member of a class is known for all.

No actual pitch pattern—such as that of the 'isolate' pronunciation—is directly indicated for each entry. Instead, a number in Roman figures will be found in parentheses after all classified entries (where classification has not seemed feasible within the

limitations of the dictionary, (u)—for 'Unclassified'—will be found). This number is that of the tonal class to which the word in question belongs within the wider class of grammatically similar words of the same syllabic length of STEM: it refers to the total range of pitch patterns of the item concerned over all contexts in which it occurs. A small selection only of such contexts needs to be examined for classificatory purposes, and the method by which the number may in practice be arrived at is explained below for each tonally classified category in turn.

No special merit is claimed for the system of numbering used. The tonal classification has grown up perforce with the dictionary, and is certainly capable of some refinement in both method and detail. Furthermore, the originator of the system has not been able to supervise in detail its application by a variety of Kikuyu assistants to material with only a fraction of which he is personally familiar. Some inaccuracies seem inevitable—especially in the case of the nouns—and indulgence is craved on the part of those who may be in a position to detect them. It seemed, however, essential to give as much information as possible in this field while the opportunity presented itself; and it is hoped that any limitations or inaccuracies may be made good in subsequent editions.

In what follows, pitch patterns are shown graphically by the use of one mark per syllable located between parallel lines of which the upper is intended to represent relatively high pitch, the lower relatively low pitch. The marks, which read from left to right, consist of lines which are horizontal when they stand for level pitch, slope downwards when they indicate falling pitch, and slope upwards when they indicate rising pitch. The compound sign $\supset$ indicates that alternative pitch patterns appear to be acceptable, one involving a fall in pitch, the other a level pitch at the height shown.

Verbs

The classification of verbs is relatively straightforward, and can be determined exclusively by reference to the nomino-verbal form.

Those verbs whose singular imperative consists of a single syllable—e.g. *te* (discard), *tua* (pluck)—require no classification as such, since they all behave alike, having for, instance,

- (e.g. *te*) and - / e.g. *gũte*

as the patterns as isolates of their singular imperative and nomino-

verbal forms respectively. For every other length of verb stem there are two contrastive tonal possibilities in the 'infinitival' form. The classes are as shown in the accompanying table.

TABLE OF VERBS

<i>No. of syllables in stem</i>	<i>Class No.</i>	<i>Example</i>	<i>Pattern of Isolate Nomino-Verbal (i.e. kũ(gũ) + stem)</i>
1	One class only	te (discard)	--'
2	1	rora (look at)	---
	2	tema (cut)	--'
3	1	teng'era (run)	----
	2	hītũka (pass)	--_
4	1	garagara (roll)	-----
	2	rũmĩrĩra (follow)	--'---
5	1	gũrangĩrĩra (buy a few more of)	-----
	2	rũmangĩrĩra (follow a little further)	--'---
6	1	teng'ateng'ereria (run quickly with to)	-----
	2	twaratwarĩrĩra (push closer to)	--'-----

Nouns and adjectives

The tonal classification of nouns is more complex than that of verbs, both because of their considerably greater variety and because the pronunciation of a noun as a lexical isolate is in many cases not an infallible guide to its overall classification. In order to remove all possibility of error in assigning a noun to a particular tonal class, it has been found necessary to examine

its tonal behaviour in three other typical contexts which have been found to be adequately diagnostic. These contexts are as follows:

- (a) *Nĩ* — (It is a —),
 (b) *Tĩ* — (It is not a —),
 (c) — *nĩ* —*ega* (A — is good),

where the long dashes represent the noun being tested, and the short one in (c) the appropriate concordial prefix. The tables which follow accordingly give the tonal patterns of nouns not only as lexical isolates but also as they appear in the given contexts—the patterns being those of the whole complex, not of the noun alone. By the application of all these tests together any noun not given in the dictionary which may be encountered may be classified—unless by chance it should belong to a class not hitherto recorded.

The 'number of syllables' referred to in the tables is that of the stem, i.e. of the noun minus all prefixes. Thus though *kĩhaato*, *mbũri*, and *kiugo* have, as complete words, three, two, and two syllables respectively, their patterns are all to be found—in the appropriate column—in the table for STEMS of two syllables. The great majority of nouns have only one prefix (at any given time), and pitch patterns are not in general given separately for those with more than one, since the dictionary normally gives a cross-reference for such words to a simpler form from the tonal classification of which the basically similar tonal behaviour of the longer form may invariably be predicted. In the special case of those derivative nouns (e.g. *mwĩtĩio* (conceit)) which contain the reflexive element *-ĩ-*, this too should be removed before the stem syllables are counted; and to assist in the identification of this element the symbol R occurs after the number of the tonal class. Thus *mwĩtĩio* is shown as (III-R), since *mũtĩio* (i.e. *mwĩtĩio* minus *-ĩ-*) would fall into Class III of the nouns with disyllabic stem.

Compound nouns, in so far as these are given as head entries, have been classified in terms of their constituent elements. Thus *mũimba-igũrũ* (species of climbing plant) is given as (III-I) and *ndaara-na-rũũa* (meat adhering to hide) as (III-U-III).

The phonetic form of prefix and stem has a bearing on the pitch patterns of the complexes that the noun forms with the classificatory contexts, since these patterns necessarily vary with the total number of syllables involved and since in some cases the length of a particular syllable is a relevant factor. The following tables

are accordingly subdivided where necessary into four columns, of which:

- (1) the first gives the patterns found with a consonant-initial stem and a prefix consisting of a consonant and a vowel, e.g. *kĩ-ng'ang'i* (crocodile);
- (2) the second gives the patterns found with a consonant-initial stem and a non-syllabic prefix consisting of a homorganic nasal (e.g. *m-bũri* (goat)), or of the equivalent 'hidden' nasality which likewise lengthens a preceding vowel (e.g. *thaani* (plate)); of a vowel only (e.g. *i-ng'ang'i* (crocodiles)); or of nothing at all, i.e. a zero-prefix (e.g. *biithii* (provincial commissioner)) where words of this form take the same patterns;
- (3) the third gives the patterns found with vowel-initial stems and a prefix consisting of consonant-vowel or of the *ũ* (before *i*) or *w-* of Class 14 nouns; and
- (4) the fourth gives the patterns of words with zero-prefix where these differ from those in the second column.

Vowel stems encountered with the prefix *a-* of Class 2, which fuses with the initial vowel of the stem to form a single syllable, which itself then similarly fuses with preceding *nĩ* or *ti* (e.g. *airũtu* (young women), *eehia* (sinners)), should be classified by taking the form of the singular (e.g. *mũirĩtu*, *mwĩhia*).

The classification of loan-words has proved exceedingly laborious and remains somewhat tentative and not necessarily exhaustive. Loan-words account for most of the cases of zero-prefix; where the patterns in such cases diverge from those found with the other categories for which the second column is intended to cater, they are shown separately. It should be noted that where a loan-word begins with a short vowel which has the form of a Kikuyu prefix, this is frequently treated as such, as in *icooreethi* (insurance), the operative length of the stem being thereby reduced by one syllable as compared with the form found in the language of origin. This does not normally happen with long vowels in loan-words. It may be remarked here that the ordinary short vowel prefixes join with the final vowel of the preceding word to form a single syllable, so that the resultant complex has no more syllables than is the case with a noun with no prefix or with one consisting of non-syllabic nasality.

Kikuyu adjectives are similar in structure to Kikuyu nouns, and their tonal behaviour, in so far as they may appear in comparable

contexts, follows parallel lines. They have accordingly been classified on essentially the same basis, and no special tables are necessary. Thus, for example, the entry *-kuhĩ* (IV) indicates that for instance *Nĩ nguĩhĩ* (It is short) has the same tonal pattern as *Nĩ ngũkũ* (It is a chicken), since *ngũkũ* is also classified as (IV).

The quasi-participial derivatives in *-ĩ*, *-e*, and *-u* which may be formed from most verbs follow the same lines, and some of these—even if at times somewhat hypothetical—have in fact been used to fill up the more serious gaps in the tables where no noun of the requisite pattern seemed available.

Note 1. Wherever in column 2 of the pitch patterns the first mark is enclosed in parentheses, it should be understood that the syllable to which that mark refers is present only in the case of the V-prefix words: in other cases the pattern should be read without the mark in question.

Note 2. The symbol M which occurs at the end of certain patterns stands for 'mid', and is added to ensure that the interval between the pitch of the last syllable and that of either the whole or the beginning (in the case of a falling tone) of the syllable before it is a narrow one: a contrastively greater interval with final 'low' (not marked) is also possible in similar circumstances, as careful attention to the spacing will show.

MONOSYLLABIC STEMS

Class No.	1		2		Isolate pattern
	CV-Prefix		N-Prefix or V-Prefix		
1	mũri	(a) ˘\˘	ngo	(a) \˘	(-)-
		(b) ---		(b) --	
		(c) ˘˘˘˘		(c) (˘)˘˘˘	
2	mũtĩ	(a) ˘˘˘	ndĩ	(a) ˘˘˘	(-)-
		(b) ˘˘˘		(b) ˘˘˘	
		(c) ˘˘˘˘		(c) (˘)˘˘˘	
3	rũkũ	(a) ˘˘˘˘	ngũ	(a) ˘˘˘˘	(-)˘
		(b) ˘˘˘˘ _M		(b) ˘˘˘˘ _M	
		(c) ˘˘˘˘˘		(c) (˘)˘˘˘˘	
4	mũthũ	(a) ---		(a)	--
		(b) ˘\˘˘˘ _M		(b)	
		(c) ˘˘˘˘˘		(c)	

DISYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
1	gîteke	(a) -- --	ndaka	(a) -\ -
		(b) ----		(b) ---
		(c) --- - -		(c) (-) --- - -
2	kîgunyû	(a) -- - /	njagî	(a) -- - /
		(b) --- -		(b) -- -
		(c) --- - -		(c) (-) --- - -
3	kîhaato	(a) -- - -	mbembe	(a) - - -
		(b) -- \ - _M		(b) - \ - _M
		(c) -- - - -		(c) (-) - - - -
4	kîng'ang'i	(a) -- - -	ngûkû	(a) - - -
		(b) -- \ -		(b) - \ -
		(c) -- - - -		(c) (-) - - - -
5	kîrungu	(a) -- - -	njeege	(a) - - -
		(b) -- \ - _M		(b) - \ - _M
		(c) - - - - -		(c) (-) - - - -

STEMS

³ <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		⁴ <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
kīama	(a) ⁻ \-		(a)	(-)--
	(b) ---		(b)	
	(c) ⁻ - ⁻ -		(c)	
kiugū	(a) ⁻ - ^ˈ		(a)	(-)--
	(b) ⁻ -		(b)	
	(c) ⁻ - ⁻ -		(c)	
kiugo	(a) ⁻ -	muku (enmity)	(a) ⁻ - ⁻	(-)--
	(b) ⁻ \- ^M		(b) ⁻ \- ^M	
	(c) ⁻ - ⁻ -		(c) ⁻ - ⁻ -	
kīeha	(a) ⁻ -		(a)	(-)--
	(b) ⁻ \-		(b)	
	(c) ⁻ - ⁻ -		(c)	
kīenyū	(a) ⁻ -		(a)	(-)--
	(b) ⁻ \- ^M		(b)	
	(c) ⁻ - ⁻ -		(c)	

DISYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
6	mūgwacī	(a) ---/	nyamū	(a) ---/
		(b) ----		(b) ---
		(c) ----_ _		(c) (-)----_ _
7	kīmitū	(a) ---M	njata	(a) ---M
		(b) ---\M		(b) ---\M
		(c) --_ _ _		(c) (-)--_ _ _
8	matūūra	(a) ---/	thaani	(a) ---/
		(b) ---/		(b) ---/
		(c) --_ _ _		(c) (-)--_ _ _
9	gīcūhī	(a) ---\ _	njūūi	(a) ---\ _
		(b) ---\ _*		(b) ---\ _
		(c) --_ _ _		(c) (-)--_ _ _†
10		(a)	nyaanya (tomato)	(a) ---/
		(b)		(b) ---\ _
		(c)		(c) --_ _ _

* Or ---\ _.

† In the case of njūūi itself, there appears to be an alternative pattern --_ _ _.

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14		⁴ Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2		Isolate pattern
	(a)		(a)	(-)-/
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	()		(a)	(-)--
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
kiuga	(a) --/		(a)	(-)-/
	(b) --/		(b)	
	(c) --_--		(c)	
	(a)	biya (beer)	(a) -\-	(-)\-
	(b)		(b) -\-	
	(c)		(c) --_--	
	(a)		(a)	\-
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	

DISYLLABIC

<i>Class No.</i>	¹ <i>Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix</i>		² <i>Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix</i>	
11		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
12		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		⁴ <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
	(a)	cibũ (chief) tobu (top gear)	(a) ---	--
	(b)		(b) -\ -M	
	(c)		(c) - - - -	
	(a)	murũ (im- provement, superiority)	(a) ---	--
	(b)		(b) -\ -	
	(c)		(c) - - - -	

TRISYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
1	kīberethi	(a) ------	mbogoro	(a) ----
		(b) -----		(b) ----
		(c) ----_--		(c) (⁀)----_--
2	mūrīmire (way of cultivating)	(a) ------	nīmire < -rīmīra	(a) --_--
		(b) ----_		(b) --_
		(c) ----_--		(c) (⁀)----_--
3	kīgoo- koora	(a) --_	mbariki	(a) ^_
		(b) ----_		(b) --_
		(c) --_--		(c) (⁀)--_--
4	kīhengere	(a) ------	ngagaca	(a) ^----
		(b) ----_--		(b) --_--
		(c) ----_--		(c) (⁀)----_--
5	kībobooto	(a) --_--/	ndaraca	(a) --_--/
		(b) ----_		(b) ----_
		(c) ----_--		(c) (⁀)----_--

STEMS

³ Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14		⁴ Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2		Isolate pattern
kiunguru	(a) -- --		(a)	(-)---
	(b) ----		(b)	
	(c) --- --		(c)	
mwathire (way of governing)	(a) -- --		(a)	(-)---
	(b) -- _		(b)	
	(c) --- --		(c)	
kiumiri	(a) - _	thimiti (cement) (cl. 14)	(a) - _	(-) - _
	(b) - _		(b) - _ or - _	
	(c) - - -		(c) - - -	
kĩariũngũ	(a) - - -		(a)	(-)---
	(b) -- --		(b)	
	(c) --- --		(c)	
kĩama-ita	(a) -- - /		(a)	(-)---
	(b) --- -		(b)	
	(c) --- - -		(c)	

TRISYLLABIC

Class No.	1		2	
	Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
6	kīgo- ngoona	(a) --_--	ngamiira	(a) --_--
		(b) ---\-M		(b) ---\-M
		(c) ---_--		(c) (-)---_--
7	mūbariiti	(a) --_--	mbaciici	(a) --_--
		(b) ---\-M		(b) ---\-M
		(c) --_--_--		(c) (-)--_--_--
8	gītayaaya	(a) --_--	ngūngūni	(a) --_--
		(b) ---_--		(b) ---_--
		(c) -_---_--		(c) (-)-_---_--
9	kīng'aurū	(a) --_--	mbahaca	(a) -_---
		(b) ---\-M		(b) ---\-M
		(c) --_--_--		(c) (-)--_--_--
10	gīting'ūri	(a) --_-'	ndigithū	(a) --_-'
		(b) ---_-'		(b) ---_-'
		(c) --_--_--		(c) (-)--_--_--

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14		⁴ Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2		Isolate pattern
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	(-)--
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	(-)--
	(c)		(c)	
weereere	(a) --_	baatĩrĩ (Catholic Father)	(a) --_	
	(b) --_		(b) --_	(-)-
	(c) --_--		(c) --_--	
mwarimũ (teacher)	(a) --_M		(a)	
	(b) --_M		(b)	(-)-
	(c) --_--		(c)	
kĩĩgunyĩ	(a) --_		(a)	
	(b) --_		(b)	(-)-
	(c) --_--		(c)	

TRISYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
11	gikunguĩ	(a) ---M	ngunguĩ	(a) ---M
		(b) ---M		(b) ---M
		(c) ---		(c) (-) ---
12	king'a- ratua	(a) ---		(a)
		(b) ---\		(b)
		(c) ---		(c)
13		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
14		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
15	gaco- roorua	(a) ---	Ndirangũ	(a) ---
		(b) ---M		(b) ---M
		(c) ---		(c) (-) ---

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		⁴ <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
kiūngūyū	(a) ---M		(a)	
	(b) ---M		(b)	(-)-M
	(c) ---		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	(-)---
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)	thabai	(a) ---	
	(b)		(b) ---	(-)---
	(c)		(c) ----	
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	(-)---
	(c)		(c)	

TRISYLLABIC

Class No.	¹ Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		² Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
16	karaagita (tractor)	(a) --- _-	ngeereci (garage)	(a) ^- _-
		(b) ----		(b) ^^--
		(c) -^---- _-		(c) (-)^---- _-

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		⁴ <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
	(a)	baamīti (permit) iinjini (engine)	(a) -- --	(-) -- --
	(b)		(b) -- --	
	(c)		(c) - - - -	

TETRASYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
1	kīboro- boro	(a) -- ----	mbūrū- būrū	(a) -- ----
		(b) -----		(b) -----
		(c) ----- _ _		(c) (-) ----- _ _
2	kīmenyi- thania	(a) -- -- --	ngūra- ngangu < -gūra	(a) -- -- --
		(b) ----- _ _		(b) ----- _ _
		(c) ----- _ _		(c) (-) ----- _ _
3	gīthaga- thago	(a) -- - _ _	mbugi- rīrio	(a) -- - _ _
		(b) --- - _ _		(b) --- - _ _
		(c) -- - _ _ _		(c) (-) -- - _ _ _
4	kīriri- kania	(a) -- _ ----	ngocorai	(a) -- _ ----
		(b) --- ----		(b) --- ----
		(c) -- ---- _ _		(c) (-) -- ---- _ _
5	kīgoro- goru	(a) -- - _ _		(a)
		(b) --- _ _		(b)
		(c) -- - _ _ _		(c)

STEMS

³ Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14		⁴ Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2		Isolate pattern
kiambũrĩro	(a) -- ---		(a)	
	(b) -----		(b)	(-)-----
	(c) -----		(c)	
wonjorithia	(a) -- ---		(a)	
	(b) --- --		(b)	(-)-----
	(c) -----		(c)	
gĩeterero	(a) -- --		(a)	
	(b) -- --		(b)	(-)- --
	(c) -- -- --		(c)	
mũina- ngangu < -ina	(a) -- ----		(a)	
	(b) -- ----		(b)	(-)-----
	(c) -----		(c)	
kĩihutaatĩ	(a) -- --		(a)	
	(b) -- --		(b)	(-)- --
	(c) -- -- --		(c)	

TETRASYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
6	gĩthembe- recũ	(a) -- ---- /	mbiri- ginya	(a) -- ---- /
		(b) ---- -		(b) ---- -
		(c) ---- - -		(c) (-) ---- - -
7	gati- raahũgĩ (small turtle-dove)	(a) -- ---- -	ndiraa- hũgĩ	(a) -- ---- -
		(b) ---- \ -		(b) ---- \ -
		(c) ---- - -		(c) (-) ---- - -
8	gathanda- mbũirũ	(a) -- - - /		(a)
		(b) ---- - /		(b)
		(c) -- - - -		(c)
9		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
10	gĩcinicini (under- hand act)	(a) -- - - -	mbitĩkĩra	(a) -- - - -
		(b) ---- > - _M		(b) ---- > - _M
		(c) ---- - - -		(c) (-) ---- - - -

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		⁴ <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
	(a)		(a)	(-)-----
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	(-)-----
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
kĩambĩ- rĩria (beginning)	(a) -- _ --	carahani	(a) -- _ --	----
	(b) --- --M		(b) --- \ --M	
	(c) -- ^ _ _		(c) -- ^ _ _	
	(a)		(a)	(-)----
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	

TETRASYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
11		(a)	mbūkīrīra (of a sudden)	(a) ⁻ --M
		(b)		(b) ⁻ --M
		(c)		(c) ⁻ --
12		(a)	ndarubiini (telescope)	(a) ⁻ --
		(b)		(b) ⁻ --M
		(c)		(c) ⁻ --
13		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
14	gategi- thimo (catechism)	(a) ⁻ --\		(a)
		(b) ⁻ ----\		(b)
		(c) ⁻ ----		(c)
15		(a)	nyamĩ- ndigi (bush- thrush)	(a) ⁻ --M
		(b)		(b) ⁻ --M or ⁻ --M
		(c)		(c) ⁻ --

STEMS (*cont.*)

3 Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14		4 Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2		Isolate pattern
kūirorerwa	(a) - - - - M		(a)	- - - M
	(b) - - - - M		(b)	
	(c) - - - - -		(c)	
kiandarūña (awning)	(a) - - - -		(a)	- - - -
	(b) - - - \ - M		(b)	
	(c) - - - - -		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
mūitariani (Italian)	(a) - - \ -	thara- mara	(a) - - \ -	(-) - - \ -
	(b) - - - \ -		(b) - - - \ -	
	(c) - - - - -		(c) - - - - -	
	(a)		(a)	- - - - M
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	

TETRASYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
16		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
17		(a)		(a)
		(b)		(b)
		(c)		(c)
18		(a)	mbu- raaũthi (blouse)	(a) ^-_-_-
		(b)		(b) ^-_-_-
		(c)		(c) ^-_-_-_-

STEMS (*cont.*)

3 <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		4 <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
	(a)		(a)	
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)	beetinarĩ (Veterinary Depart- ment)	(a) --_--	
	(b)		(b) --_---	-_---
	(c)		(c) ^_----_--	
	(a)	rokĩĩconi (location)	(a) --^_--	
	(b)		(b) --^_--	--^_--
	(c)		(c) --^_----_--	

PENTASYLLABIC

Class No.	1 Consonant Stems with CV-Prefix		2 Consonant Stems with N-Prefix, V-Prefix, Zero-Prefix	
6		(a)	ndemoo- kirathī (democracy)	(a) - - - - -
		(b)		(b) - - - - -
		(c)		(c) - - - - -
7		(a)	koori- buraaū (cauliflower) ndabū- riūndii (P.W.D.)	(a) - - - - \ -
		(b)		(b) - - - - \ -
		(c)		(c) - - - - -
8		(a)	tere- biiceni (television)	(a) - - - - -
		(b)		(b) - - - - -
		(c)		(c) - - - - -

STEMS (*cont.*)

³ <i>Vowel Stems with CV-Prefix or Prefix of Class 14</i>		⁴ <i>Zero-Prefix where patterns differ from those of column 2</i>		<i>Isolate pattern</i>
	(a)		(a)	- - - -
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	- - - \ -
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	
	(a)		(a)	- - - -
	(b)		(b)	
	(c)		(c)	

Ideophones

Although these words fall into a very small number of tonal classes it has been found very difficult to give them a definitive classification, since in very many cases there appear to be alternative possibilities. In such cases Mr. Karīmi has attempted to give, in order of preference if any, all the versions which seemed acceptable. It is hoped that further research will eventually clarify this comparative indeterminacy; meanwhile it has seemed preferable to tabulate the patterns that may be heard without actual exemplification. Where such a variety of meaning is involved it is impossible to find a single context which is idiomatically satisfactory for all the words in question: the patterns given are those that would be heard after *gamba* (Go* . . .!) or another word of the same tonal class.

IDEOPHONES

<i>Length of word</i>	<i>Class No.</i>	<i>Pattern of Gamba— (see text)</i>
Monosyllabic	All	- \ -
Disyllabic	1	- - - -
	2	- - - /
	3	- - - - M
Trisyllabic	1	- - - - -
	2	- - - - /
Tetrasyllabic	1	- - - - - -
	2	- - - - - /
Pentasyllabic	1	- - - - - - -
	2	- - - - - - /

* i.e. as in English 'go bang!', &c.

This section of the Introduction comprises all the information about the tonal characteristics of Kikuyu that can reasonably be included in a dictionary. As will have become apparent from the tables, the tonal outline of a Kikuyu word or stem may differ markedly from one context to another, and a full description of these complex changes cannot be given here. The classification that has been attempted in these pages will nevertheless, it is hoped, go a long way towards ensuring that once the behaviour of one member of a class has been observed, any other member of the class may with some confidence be treated in the same way.

ABBREVIATIONS

a.	adjective, preceded by ad- jectival concords.	n.	noun.
abb.	abbreviation of, abbreviated.	n.c.	nominal concord.
a.c.	adjectival concord.	neg.	negative.
adv.	adverb, adverbial concord.	N.K.	current in the Northern parts of Kikuyu country, not confirmed by informants from the Southern area.
aff.	affirmative.	num.	numeral.
arch.	archaic, conveying a flavour of antiquity.	opp.	opposite of.
aug.	augmentative.	P.	Portuguese.
Bibl.	used in translations of the Bible.	p.a.	pronominal preceded by pro- nominal concords.
cf.	compare analogous word or phrase.	part.	particle.
coll.	colloquial usage.	partic.	participle.
conc.	concord.	p.c.	pronominal concord.
contr.	contracted.	pers.	personal.
dem.	demonstrative.	pl.	plural.
descr.	descriptive.	poss.	possessive.
E.	English (when this stands alone it signifies that the first English word used in the definition is that from which the word is derived).	prep.	preposition.
e.g.	for example.	pron.	pronoun.
esp.	especially.	q.v.	refer to the entry under the preceding word.
exp.	expressing.	R.C.	used in Roman Catholic books.
foll.	following.	ref.	reference, referring to.
G.	German.	rel.	relative.
ideo.	ideophone.	s.	singular.
imp.	imperative.	sb.	somebody.
Ind.	some Indian language.	see	look under the entry for fur- ther information.
indep.	independent.	sp.	species.
indic.	indicative.	sth.	something.
inf.	infinitive.	subj.	subjunctive.
int.	interjection.	Sw.	Swahili.
interrog.	interrogative.	usu.	usually.
Ka.	Kamba.	v.i.	intransitive verb.
Ma.	Massai.	v.t.	transitive verb.
		vv.	various.

~ repetition of the complete word at the head of the entry or of the preceding verb-root extension.

^{1,2} words of the same shape and grammatical category but distinct in meaning.

/ alternating with, having as alternative form the word which follows.

* not to be used in ordinary conversation.

[] 1. immediately after the head word shows the correct pronunciation.

2. the word enclosed at the end of an article indicates

(a) if in small caps the source of the word in another language as shown;

(b) if in ordinary type the simplest form of the word in Kikuyu.

() tonal class in Roman numerals enclosed.